

DYM&D Asset Browser - Feature Guide

1. Literally just making mapmaking a bit easier on myself.

No more clicking in and out of folders. No more trying to find all ashen furniture but JUST FURNITURE PLEASE, etc., etc. I absolutely love having access to so many assets but my brain breaks popping in and out of folders. It feels like I'm in the shared network server at work.

This guide is meant to help walk someone through how to use this weird little tool I've made (with a ton of AI help, see the AI disclosure).

Start with	Use it for
Browser	Find images using filters, tags and filename search.
Planner	Select complete wall sets, floor textures and trim independently.
Utilities (gear)	See how much space previews and rotated or flipped copies use, and clear them when needed.

The browser is just a supercharged file explorer. Your source artwork stays in its original folders. The Browser writes its index, settings and generated images separately. It contains no runtime AI integration and ships with no assets.

Drag assets straight into your artwork. Click and hold an asset's thumbnail in Browser or a populated Planner, drag it into your open Clip Studio Paint document, and release. Other graphics applications that accept image-file drag-and-drop can work too. Your original artwork stays unchanged.

DYM&D Asset Browser is independently developed and is not affiliated with or endorsed by Forgotten Adventures or CELSYS. No artwork library or CSP brush pack is included. Use your own appropriately licensed assets, whether from Forgotten Adventures, another favorite creator, or your own hand-drawn items.

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2. Register libraries

Install the application: Run the installer, or extract the portable ZIP and launch `DYM&D Asset Browser.exe`. The app is for 64-bit Windows and includes the software it needs to run. You do not need to install .NET separately. Both versions save your settings and catalog in the same place on your computer.

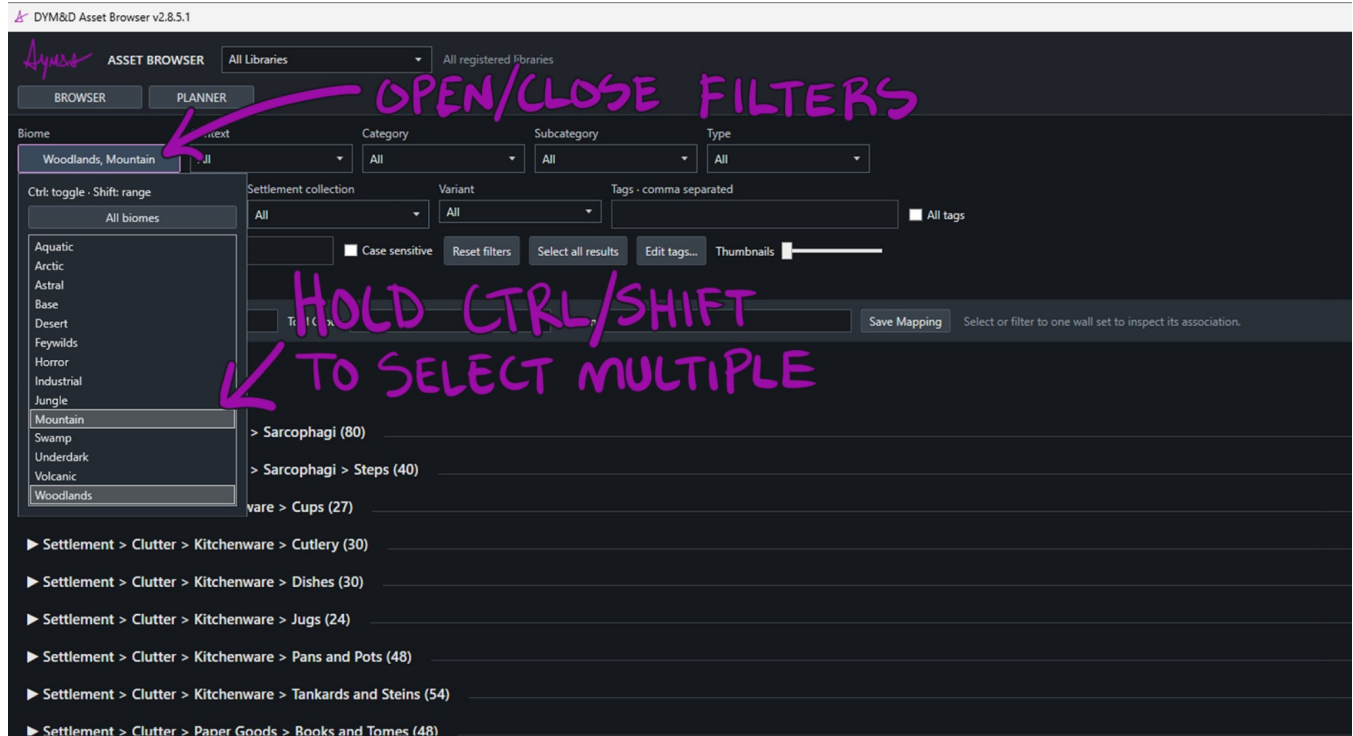
Action	What it does
Add FA...	Add your Forgotten Adventures library folder. You can also choose a folder containing that library. Keep the original filenames and folder layout so the app can recognize the assets.
Add Other...	Add another folder of images. The app uses their filenames and folders to organize them. Available filters depend on how that library is named and arranged.
Rename	Change the registered library's display name, not its files or folders.
Reindex Source / Reindex All	Rescan the selected source / every registered source for additions and changes.
Remove	Remove the library from the Browser. The original artwork stays on disk.

What to expect

- The first scan builds a saved catalog, called an index. The app loads that catalog the next time you open it.
- Adding files to the chosen library folder does not automatically update the index. Indexing must be done any time new assets are added to any of your libraries.
- Supported images are PNG, JPG/JPEG, and WebP.
- The scan includes supported images in the chosen library folder and its subfolders. See troubleshooting if a folder cannot be read or is a link to another location.
- The software is provided "as is," without warranty (see the MIT License). Bug reports are welcome and encouraged.

Windows may warn that the publisher is unknown because this app is unsigned. Download it from the project's GitHub release page. The supplied SHA-256 checksum lets you check that your download matches the published file.

3. Browse results



Browser showing assets from two selected biomes. Your library names and result counts will differ.

- Choose one library at the top, or select **All Libraries**. The status bar shows how many assets match, not just how many thumbnails are visible.
- Expand a heading to see its assets. **Expand all** and **Collapse all** sit above the results. Collapsed sections still count toward your search results.
- Thumbnails load as you scroll. The thumbnail size slider makes them larger or smaller.
- **Ctrl-click** selects individual assets; **Shift-click** selects a range. **Select all results** also includes collapsed sections. Check the selected count before bulk tag edits.

4. Filters

Filter	Question it answers	Examples
Biome	Which environment or pack area?	Base, Woodlands, Mountain, Astral
Context	What broad group does it belong to?	Wilderness, Settlement, Effects
Category	Which kind of collection?	Flora, Furniture, Structures
Subcategory	What smaller group is it in?	Building, Seating, Farming
Type	What specific kind of asset?	Walls and Curbs, Chairs, Crops

These filters attempt to follow your library's folder layout, so the available choices vary between libraries. Some images use only a few of these levels. Details from folders below **Type** can still help you find an image through search and tags.

- **All** is valid at every level. For example, you can choose **Furniture** directly without first choosing **Settlement**.

- You can select more than one biome. Other filters then show choices from those biomes. Leave **All biomes** selected to browse them all.
- Choosing a specific type can also fill in the categories it belongs to. For example, **Adobe Brickmaking** can fill **Settlement > Workplace Equipment > Tools**. If it belongs to more than one category, those choices stay open.
- Use **Materials**, **Settlement collection**, **Variant** and **Tags** alongside these filters. **Variant** is the letter or number used by the library to distinguish versions of an asset.

Biome and settlement collection are different

A Botanical Garden settlement under Woodlands belongs to the Woodlands biome and Botanical Garden collection. Base woodland settlement content belongs to Woodlands with the Base collection. Mountain and Dwarven are not interchangeable labels.

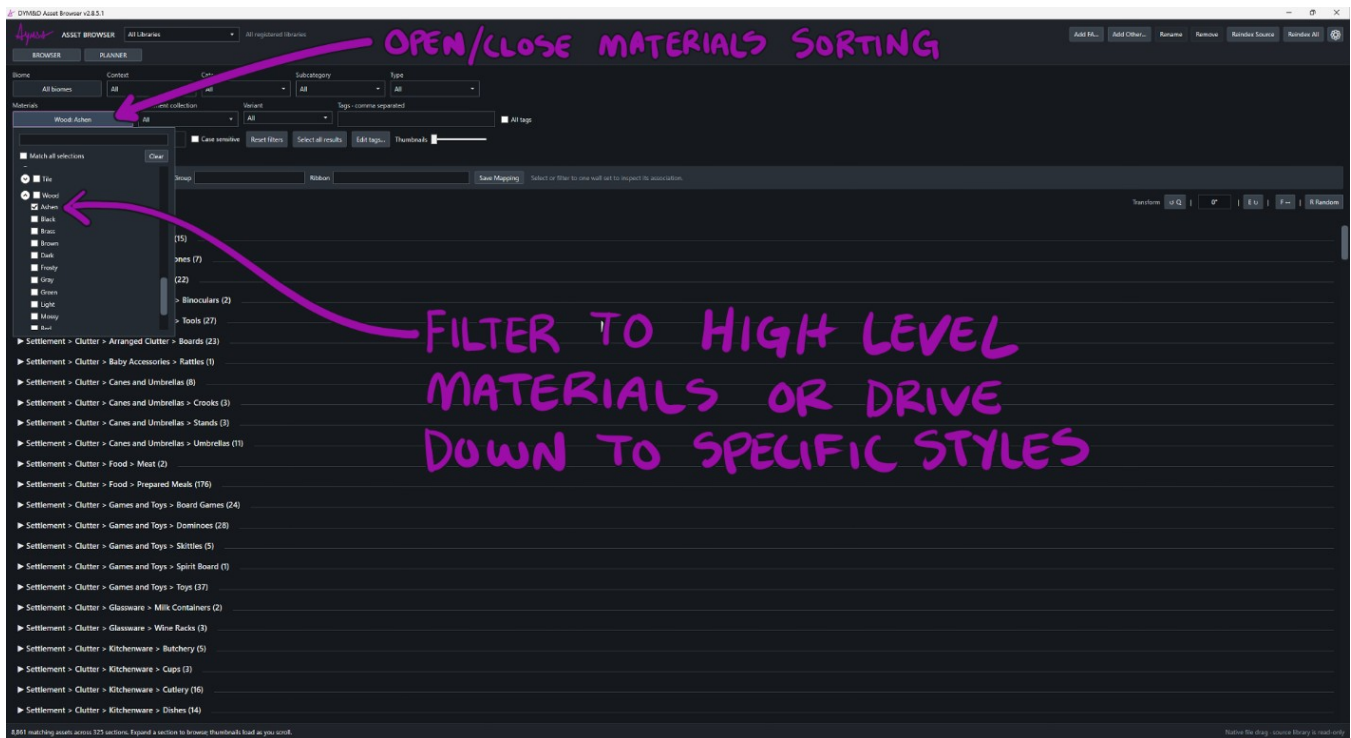
Similar pieces may be stored in different parts of a library. If you cannot find one, broaden the category and try tags or filename search.

5. Materials

Open **Materials** and check a material's name to include all its finishes, or expand it and choose individual finishes. Click the **Materials** button again to close the menu.

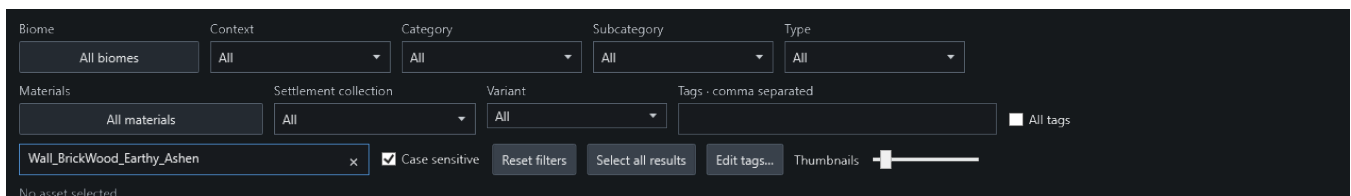
Choice	Meaning
Wood: Ashen	Find assets with ashen wood, including pieces that also contain another material.
Wood: Ashen + Brick: Earthy	With Match all selections on, find assets that contain both ashen wood and earthy brick.
Match all selections off	Any selected material/finish may match.
Exclude additional materials (Planner only)	Allow only the selected material types. Wood: Ashen then excludes Brick+Wood walls.
Checkbox beside a material name	Include every finish of that material. Expand it to choose individual finishes.

Each finish stays with its material. An earthy-brick and ashen-wood wall matches **Brick: Earthy** and **Wood: Ashen**. Assets without a material label still appear when you leave **Materials** at **All**.



In **Planner**, options with no matching results are greyed out and crossed out. You can still deselect an option you chose earlier. Some stone floors are currently listed as **Tile**; try filename search or broader material choices if you cannot find them.

6. Search and Filter to



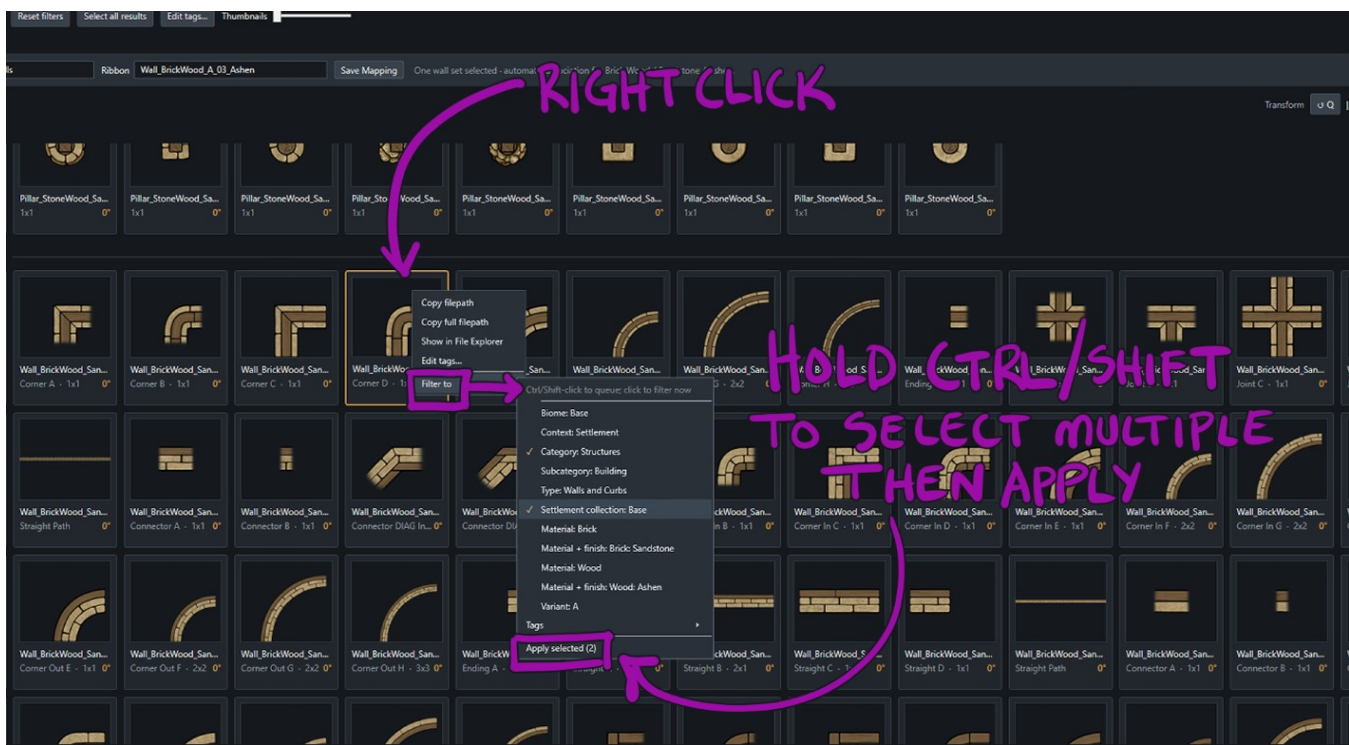
Filename search. Click X to clear the search and start typing again.

Search	Matches
Corner Ashen	Both words anywhere in the filename, in either order.
Wall "Stone_Ashen"	Wall plus the exact text Stone_Ashen.
Case sensitive	Require matching capitalization; normally leave this off.

When you find something you like

- Right-click the asset and open **Filter to**. Choose one of its categories, biomes, materials, finishes, collections, variants or tags to find similar assets.
- Click one characteristic to apply it immediately. Hold **Ctrl** or **Shift** while clicking to queue several; then choose **Apply selected**.
- **Filter to** replaces your current filters and clears the filename search. It keeps the same library selected.

- If you select several choices and close the menu without choosing **Apply selected**, your filters stay unchanged.



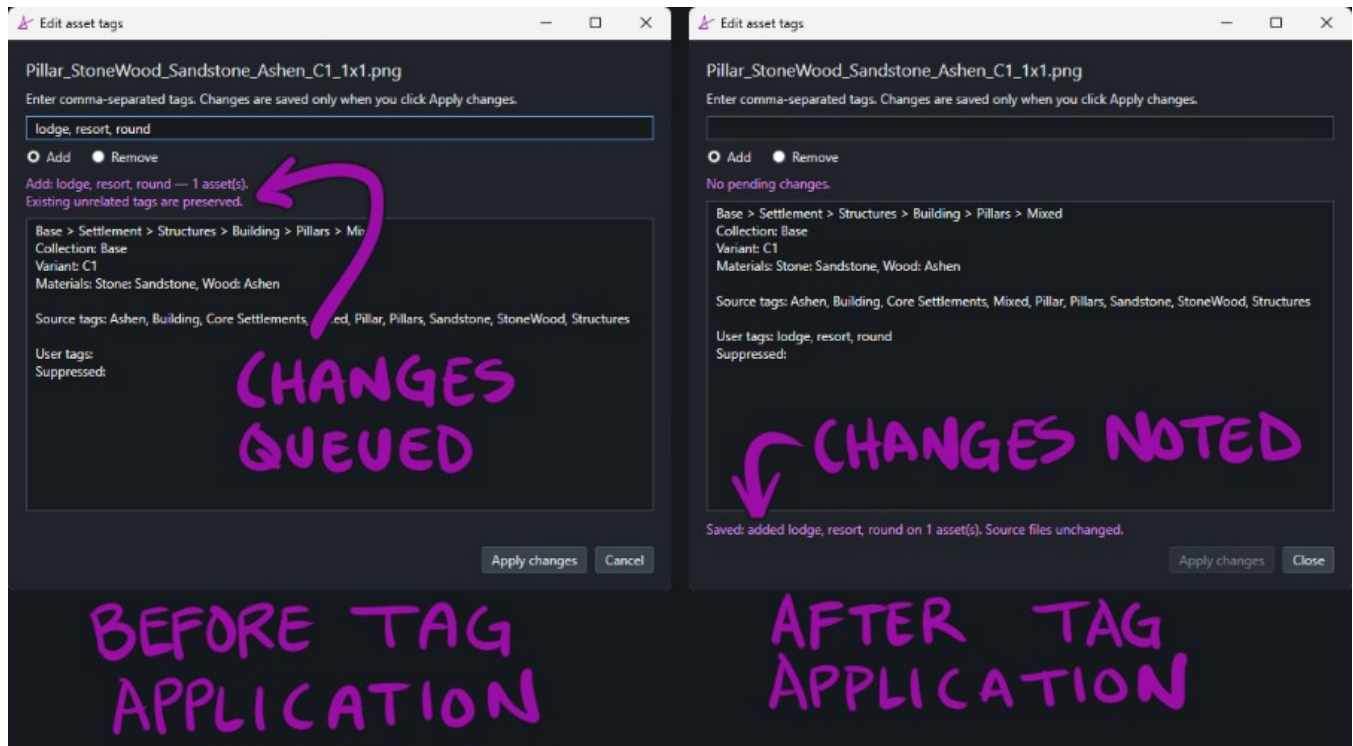
7. Tags

Select one or more assets, then choose **Edit tags...** from the **Browser** controls or the asset menu. For a large set, **Select all results** includes matching assets that have no visible thumbnail yet.

- Enter comma-separated tags and choose **Add** or **Remove**.
- Review the pending change and affected asset count.
- Choose **Apply changes** to save. The dialog shows a saved confirmation and refreshed tag information.
- Closing before applying discards the unconfirmed edit. Typing in the field alone does not save tag edits.

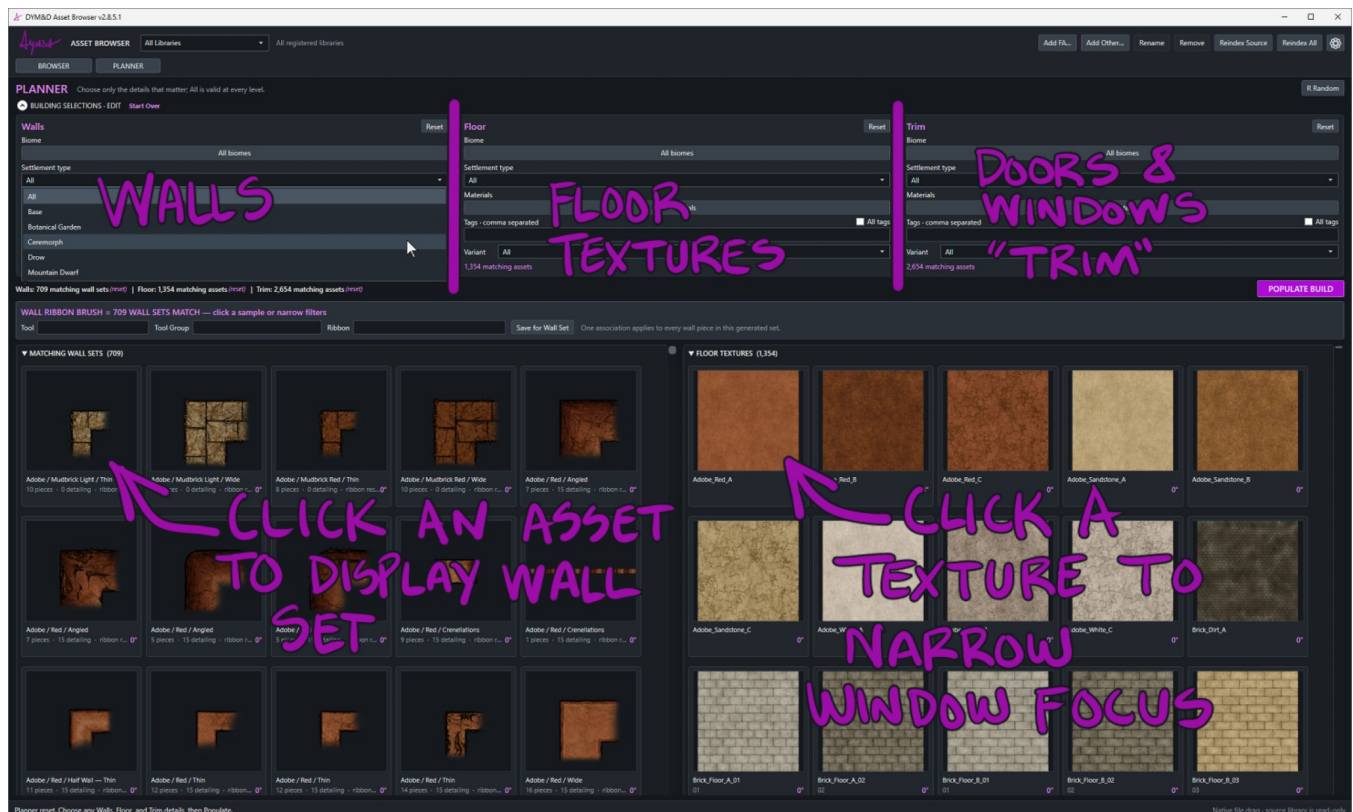
Kind of tag	What Remove does
A tag you added yourself	Removes that tag from the selected assets.
A tag the app found in a filename or folder	Hides that tag for the selected assets, including after the next scan.
A tag you previously hid	Add it again to make it visible.

To search tags, enter tags separated by commas in the Browser or Planner tag field. Normally a result can match any entered tag; checking **All tags** requires every tag. Capitalization does not matter. Enter the whole tag, such as wooden chair, rather than part of it.



Tag edits are saved in the Browser, without changing your artwork files. If you move or rename an image, check its tags after scanning again; the app may treat it as a new image.

8. Planner setup



Planner showing wall sets, floors and trim. Artwork by Forgotten Adventures (forgotten-adventures.net). Your result counts will differ.

Walls, Floor and Trim each have their own **Biome, Settlement type, Materials, Tags** and **Variant** filters. Leave any filter at **All**. Choose each part separately: changing **Walls** keeps your floor and trim choices as they are.

Walls shows one sample for each matching wall set. Click a sample to choose that set, or narrow the filters until you find it. Click a floor texture to choose that particular image. **Clear choice** removes a selected sample but keeps your filters; **Reset** clears the choices for that panel.

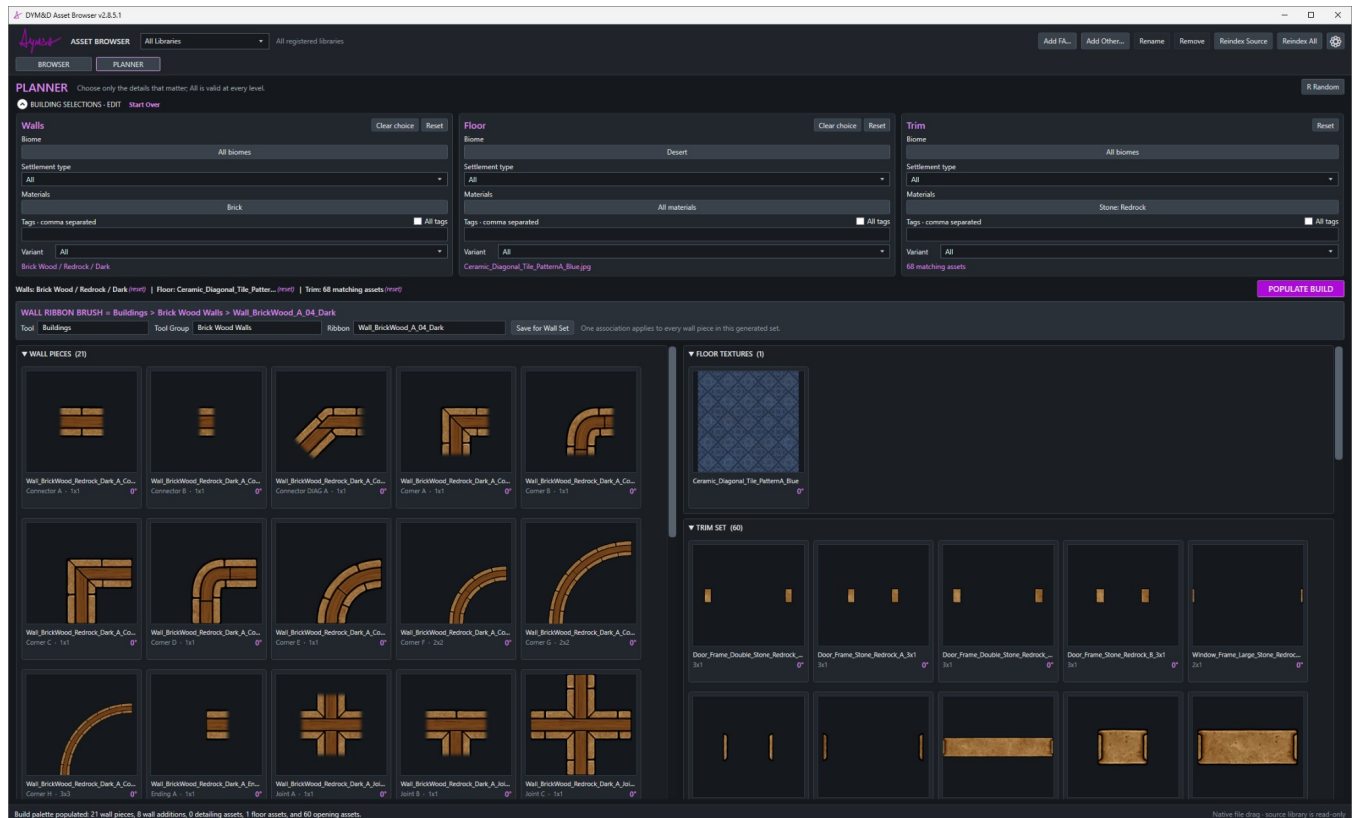
9. Ribbon Brush Assignments

- Choose **Walls, Floor and Trim**, then click **Populate Build**.
- **Wall Pieces** and related detailing are on the left. **Floor Textures** and **Trim Set** are on the right, with independent scrolling.
- **Trim** appears below **Floor Textures** in the right column.
- Return to **Building selections - Edit** to adjust the building choices. **Start Over** resets the **Planner**.

Find the ribbon brush for your wall set

The **WALL RIBBON BRUSH** area shows a brush reference for the selected wall set. Use **Tool, Tool Group** and **Ribbon** as a reminder of where to find that brush in CSP. If you organize your brushes differently, edit these fields and choose **Save for Wall Set**. The saved reference applies to the whole set, including corners, T pieces and connectors.

If several sets match, choose one or narrow the filters first. Check the suggested brush name against your installed CSP brushes and correct it if needed. A suggested name does not mean that brush is installed. The suggested **Tool** and **Tool Group** labels reflect my personal CSP setup, not groups supplied by Forgotten Adventures.



Planner gathers the pieces and brush references you need. You place the images, select your brushes, and draw in CSP yourself.

10. Transform on Transfer: Drag, rotate, flip, randomize

Control	Action
Q / E	Rotate left / right by 90 degrees.
Shift+Q / Shift+E	Rotate left / right by 45 degrees.
F	Flip horizontally.
R / Random button	Toggle random drag rotation: 0, 45, 90, 135, 180, 225, 270 or 315 degrees.

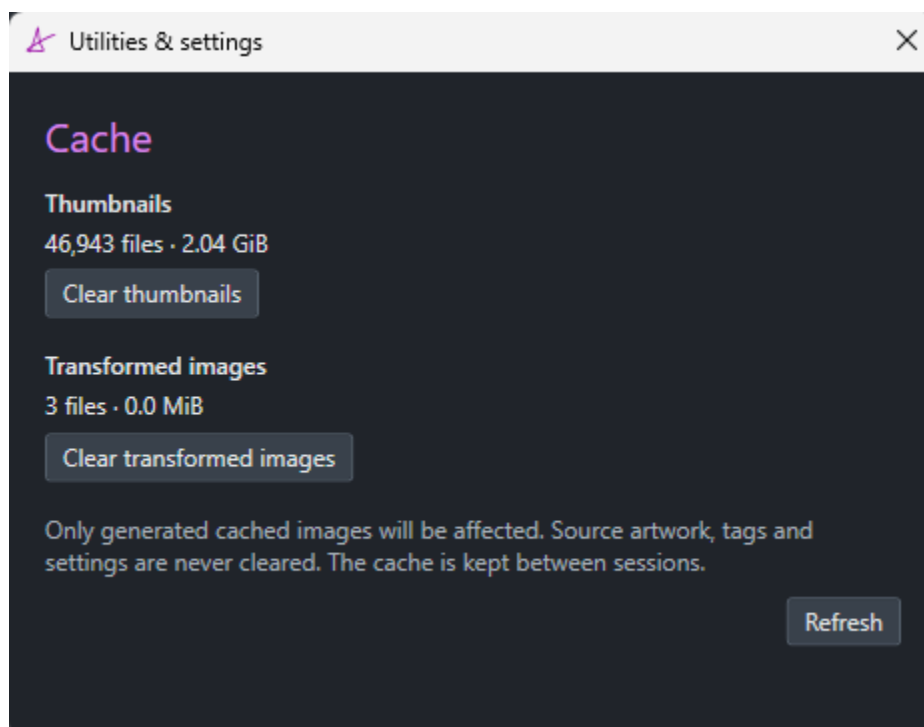
Random starts off each time you open the app. Turn it on to give each dragged image a random angle. Your flip setting stays the same. Turn **Random** off to return to the angle you chose manually. These shortcuts do not run while you are typing in a text box.

Random uses 45-degree increments so repeated rotations can reuse cached images, rather than filling the cache with nearly identical copies at slightly different angles.

Rotation and flip create a cached copy without changing your original artwork. Diagonal rotations add transparent space and may slightly soften edges.

Right-click and choose **Copy filepath** to copy a path suitable for Foundry when the app can identify one. **Copy full filepath** copies the image's full Windows location. **Show in File Explorer** opens its folder and selects the original image.

11. Cache, saved data, and recovery



Utilities and settings showing stored previews and rotated or flipped copies. Your counts and storage usage will differ.

Click the gear to open **Utilities & settings**. The cache is where the app keeps thumbnails and rotated or flipped copies. You can see how much space each group uses and clear either group. These files stay on disk between sessions until you clear them. Rotated or flipped PNG and WebP copies are counted together.

Avoid clearing cache while a file is being imported from the browser. File Objects in your CSP projects that link to cached images may stop working. Ordinary imported images are unaffected. Leave caches alone when you are unsure whether a project references them.

Saved files	Purpose
settings.json and settings.json.bak	Your libraries, settings, tag edits and brush references, plus a backup of previously saved settings.
asset-index.db	Your saved catalog of assets.
cache	Thumbnails and rotated or flipped image copies.

To find your saved data, paste %LOCALAPPDATA%\DymndAssetBrowser into File Explorer's address bar. Close the app before copying this folder for a backup. If a CSP project links to cached images, keep those files at the same paths too.

Only one copy of the app can use the same saved data at a time. If settings cannot be loaded, the app offers recovery choices and keeps the damaged file rather than automatically replacing it.

12. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
A large count but few thumbnails	Expand headings and scroll. Previews load as you reach them, rather than all at once.
An expected asset is missing	Check the selected library and filters, including tags and filename search. Clear narrow choices, then reindex if you added new files.
Wood walls include brick	Wood also matches pieces made from wood and brick. In Planner, select Wood and turn on Exclude additional materials for wood-only results.
A Planner choice gives zero results	Clear a selected sample, deselect crossed-out choices, or broaden your tags and filters. Greyed-out options have no matches with your current choices.
Stone floors appear as Tile	Some stone floors are labelled this way in 2.8.5. Broaden Materials or search by filename or tags.
A ribbon name does not match CSP	Find the brush in CSP, then update Tool , Tool Group and Ribbon for the selected wall set.
A folder is reported as linked or skipped	Choose the folder where the images are actually stored. The app does not follow special folder links that redirect to another location, including links inside your library or in the path leading to it.
A folder cannot be read	Check that the drive is connected and you can open the folder in File Explorer, then try scanning again. A failed scan keeps the previous catalog.
A WebP will not place in CSP	Try importing the file directly in CSP and check whether your CSP version supports it. Previews and transformed copies use only the first frame of an animated WebP. If reporting a problem, say whether you dragged the original or a rotated or flipped copy.

I am working on including a debug log in the future.